PRODUCT VISION & TECHNICAL SPECIFICATION

SKILL EVOLUTION NETWORK

A social platform where people build professional identity through **skills, proof, community acknowledgement, connections** and a visual progression system.

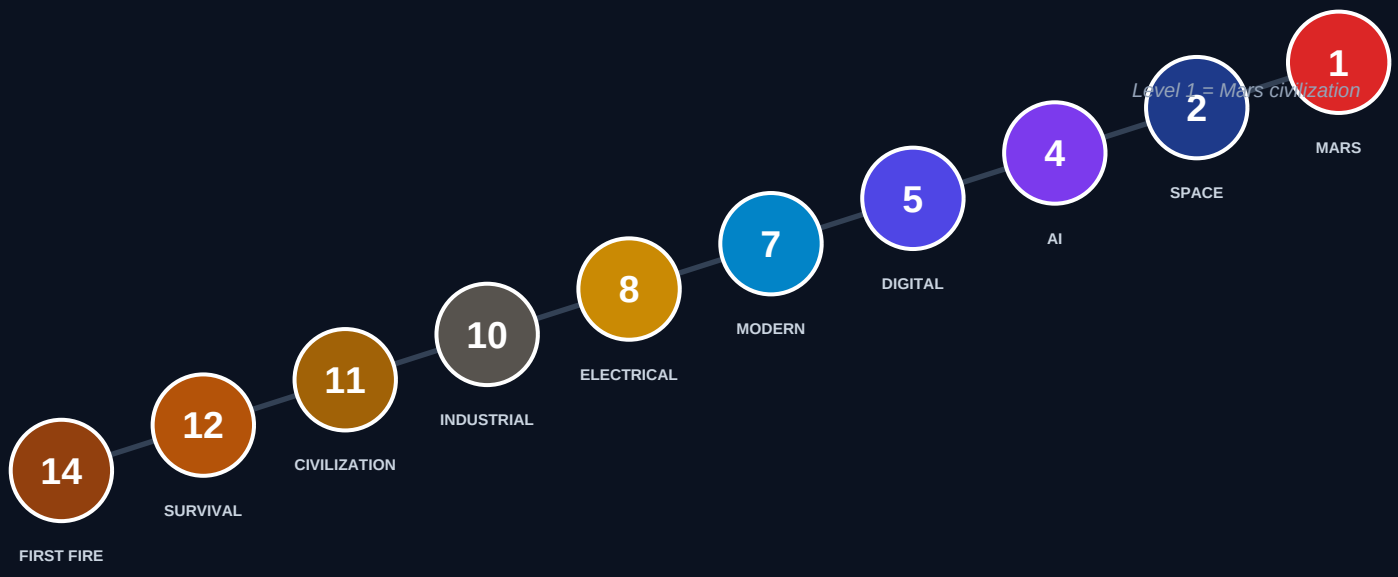
THE CORE IDEA

Working concept: a professional/social network broader than a resume. Users keep profiles of skills, certificates, projects, research, internships, jobs and links. Others can acknowledge demonstrated capabilities, connect and chat, and discover people by skill.

SIGNATURE MECHANIC

A profile has a **level from 14 down to 1**. As it gains credible evidence and community recognition, its visual identity evolves from **prehistoric humanity** to a **Mars-era civilization**.

THE LEVEL JOURNEY



Level 14 begins here

CLAIM · PROVE · ACKNOWLEDGE · PROGRESS · CONNECT

Prepared as a product / build-in-public blueprint

1 Product Vision

Why this exists and what loop drives it

PROBLEM

Existing professional profiles often become static lists of skills, certificates and job titles. This platform treats professional identity as something continuously built, evidenced and recognized.

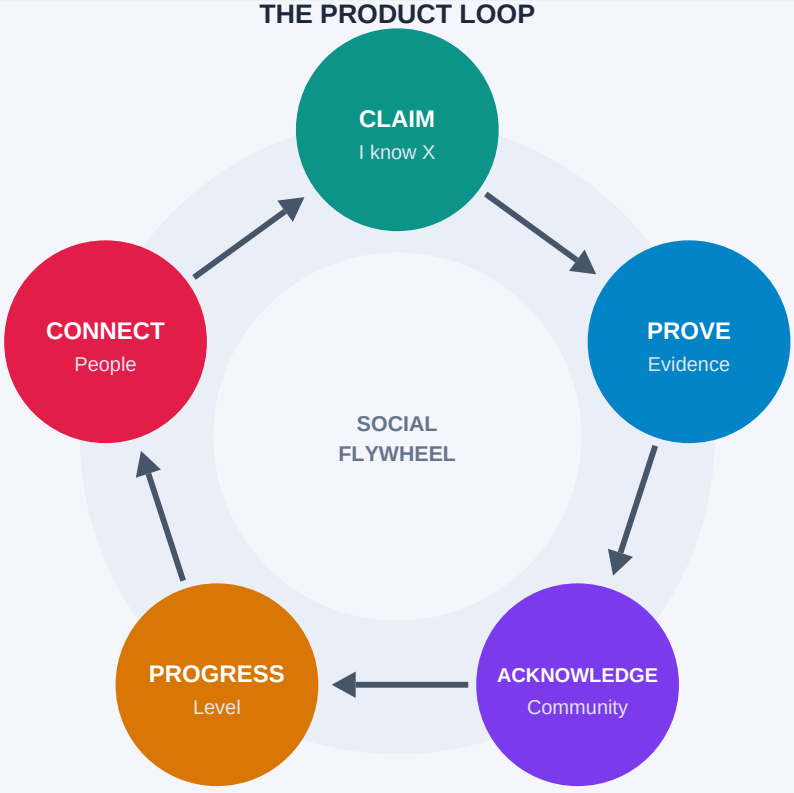
PRODUCT PROMISE

Show not only what a person claims to know, but the evidence behind it and the recognition they have earned.

LONG-TERM VISION

A searchable network of people and capabilities where users discover collaborators, mentors, candidates and peers based on demonstrated skills.

THE PRODUCT LOOP



A user creates evidence, other people discover it, acknowledge capability, connect, communicate and potentially create **more evidence**. The loop is intentionally social.

2 User Types

Five audiences, one profile model

S Student

PRIMARY USE

Build a skill profile and show projects/certificates

EXAMPLE

B.Tech student: React + ML + projects

P Professional

PRIMARY USE

Maintain work history and capability evidence

EXAMPLE

Sales executive: sales results + experience

C Creator / Freelancer

PRIMARY USE

Show portfolio and skills

EXAMPLE

Video editor: edits + portfolio links

R Researcher

PRIMARY USE

Show research and publications

EXAMPLE

Research papers + experiments

F Recruiter / Collaborator

PRIMARY USE

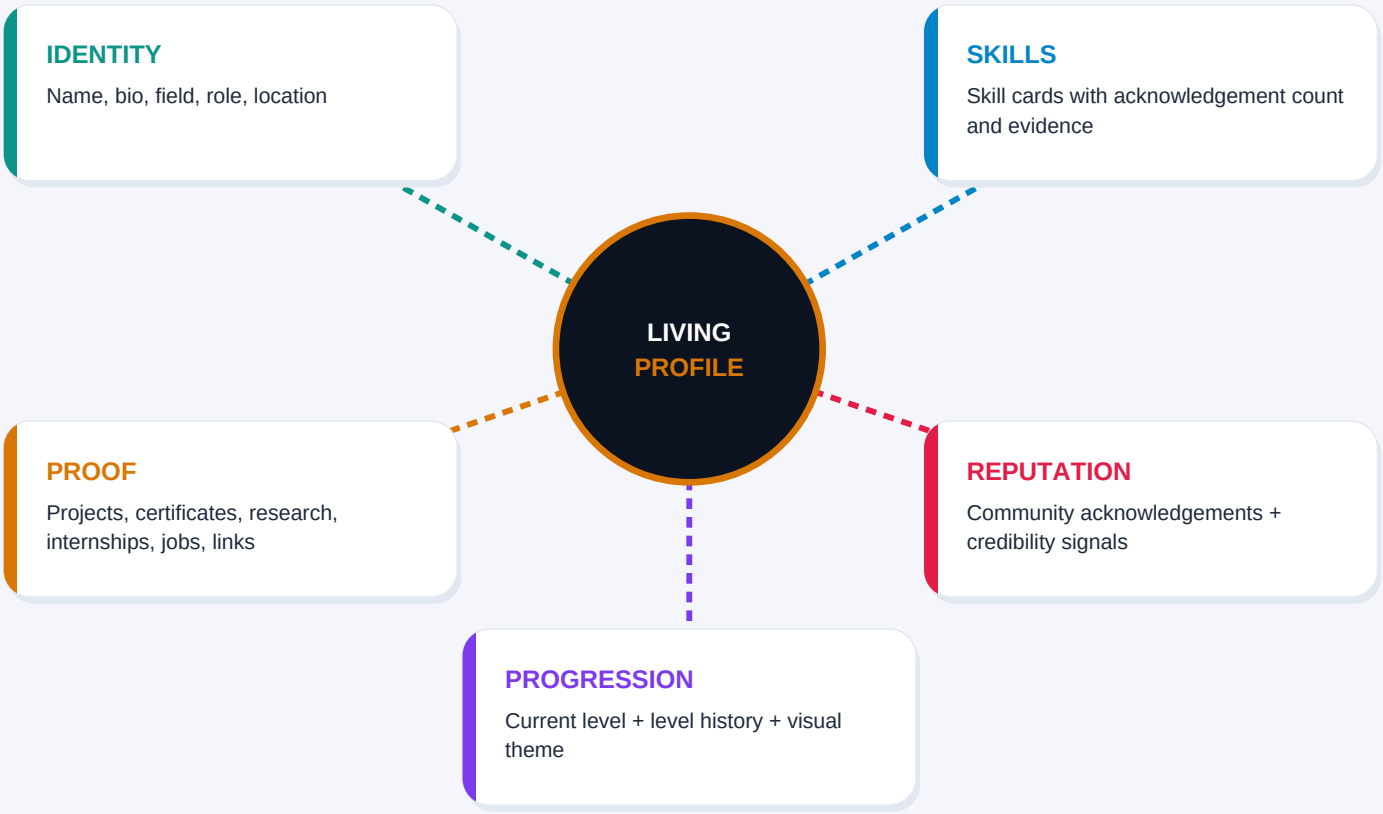
Search and evaluate people

EXAMPLE

Find verified React developers

3 Profile System

The profile is the center: a living identity, not a static CV



EXAMPLE SKILL CARD

Python

87 acknowledgements

6	1.5 yrs	2
PROJECTS	EXPERIENCE	RESEARCH

EVIDENCE LINKS

GitHub | Portfolio | Certificate

Evidence attached directly to the skill.

WHY IT MATTERS

Users attach evidence directly to a skill. This prevents the profile from becoming **only a list of self-declared claims**.

FROM CLAIM TO CREDIBLE

Self-declared claim

"I know Python"

+ proof →

Evidenced, recognized skill

projects + experience + acknowledgements

4 Proof & Evidence System

Seven evidence types, with visibility you control

P Project

DEMONSTRATES

Applied ability

EXAMPLE

Web app / ML model / campaign

C Certificate

DEMONSTRATES

Completed learning / credential

EXAMPLE

Course or certification

R Research

DEMONSTRATES

Investigation / academic work

EXAMPLE

Paper / poster / dataset

I Internship

DEMONSTRATES

Professional exposure

EXAMPLE

Company + role + duration

J Job

DEMONSTRATES

Work experience

EXAMPLE

Role + responsibilities

P Portfolio

DEMONSTRATES

External work

EXAMPLE

Website / Behance / GitHub

A Achievement

DEMONSTRATES

Recognition / competition

EXAMPLE

Award / hackathon

VISIBILITY

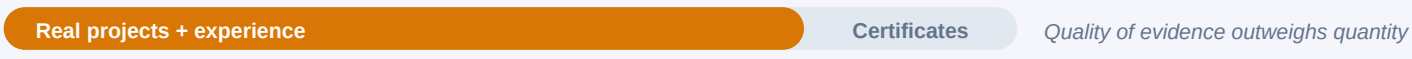
Evidence can be public, private, or visible only to approved connections depending on product settings.

Public | Private | Connections only

IMPORTANT PRODUCT PRINCIPLE

Evidence should matter **more than certificate count**. A user with real projects and experience should be able to demonstrate capability even without collecting dozens of certificates.

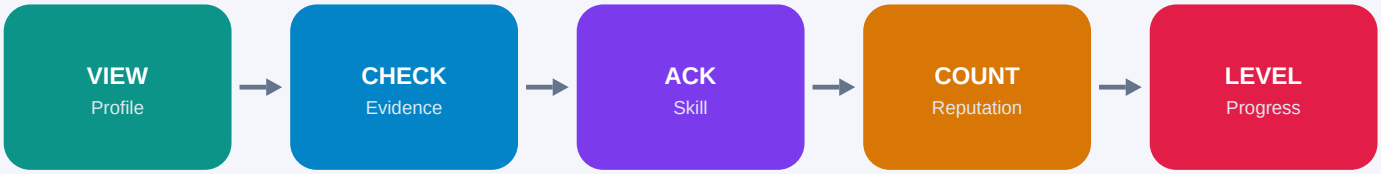
WHAT THE PROFILE REWARDS



Illustrative proportion of emphasis, not a formula.

5 Skill Acknowledgement

Skill-specific reputation signals that resist gaming

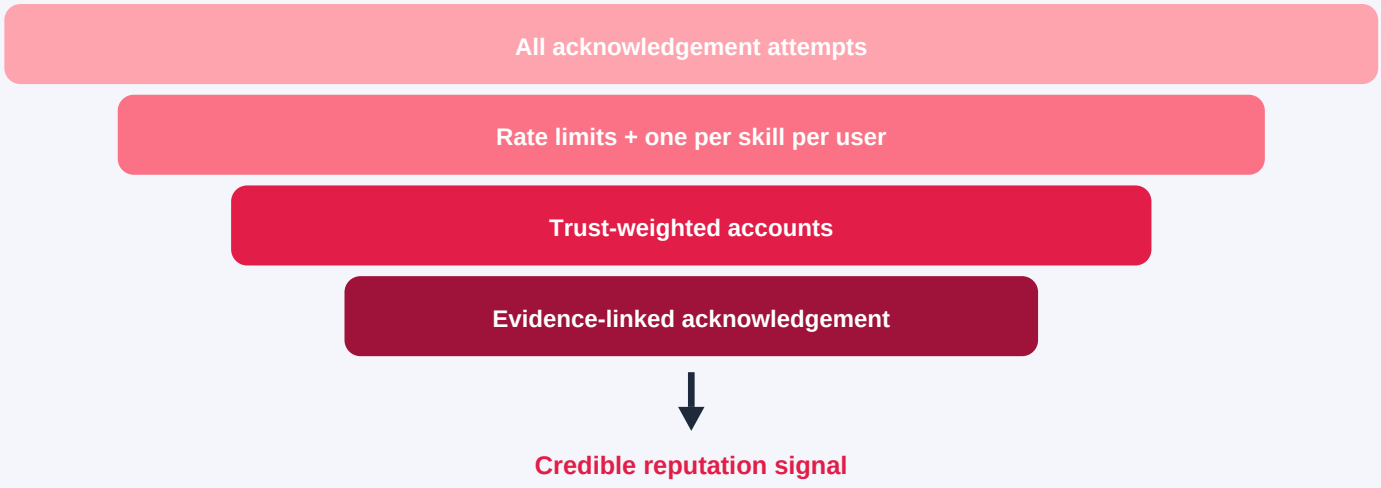


ANTI-GAMING REQUIREMENTS

A simple endorsement button can be gamed through friend-to-friend exchanges or fake accounts. The production version should consider limits and quality signals.

1. **One acknowledgement per skill per user**
   Prevents repeated votes
2. **Optional reason**
   Adds context: why the person is acknowledged
3. **Interaction history**
   Can prioritize people who actually interacted with the work
4. **Account trust signals**
   Reduce impact of newly created or suspicious accounts
5. **Rate limits**
   Limit mass acknowledgement behavior
6. **Evidence-linked acknowledgement**
   Allow acknowledgement to reference a specific project/experience

QUALITY FILTERS TURN RAW CLICKS INTO REPUTATION



6 Level & Visual Evolution

10 visible stages: lower numbers mean greater progression

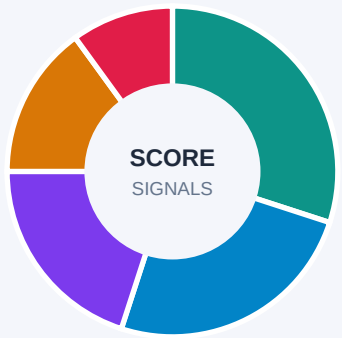


START: Level 14 — **Level 1: Mars civilization**

- **14 — FIRST FIRE**: Prehistoric / stone / fire
- **12 — SURVIVAL**: Hunter-gatherer
- **11 — CIVILIZATION**: Early settlements
- **10 — INDUSTRIAL**: Machines / industry
- **8 — ELECTRICAL**: Electric age
- **7 — MODERN**: Modern civilization
- **5 — DIGITAL**: Internet / software
- **4 — AI**: Intelligent systems
- **2 — SPACE**: Interplanetary era
- **1 — MARS**: Mars civilization

The level should be calculated from **multiple signals**, not raw acknowledgement count alone: evidence quality, experience, project depth, community acknowledgement, account trust and activity.

ILLUSTRATIVE SCORING MODEL (NOT A FINAL FORMULA)

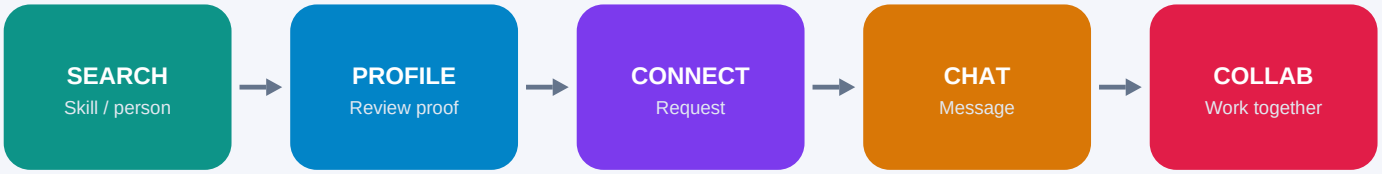


Verified / strong evidence	30%
Projects / demonstrated work	25%
Community acknowledgement	20%
Professional experience	15%
Research / achievements / activity	10%

Weights are starting assumptions for prototyping. Validate with real user behavior; never present them as an objective measure of human worth or universal professional competence.

7 Discovery, Connections & Chat

The platform is social, not only a portfolio directory



Search & discovery

Search by person, skill, field, role, project type and selected experience signals.

Skills | Level | Location (opt-in) | Availability | Experience

Connections

Connect with people to collaborate with, learn from or communicate with.

Requests | Accepted | Suggested

Chat

1-to-1 messaging supporting text, links, files and shared profile/skill cards. Later: groups, voice/video, collaboration tools.

Text | Links | Files | Profile cards

KEEP RELATIONSHIPS AND REPUTATION SEPARATE



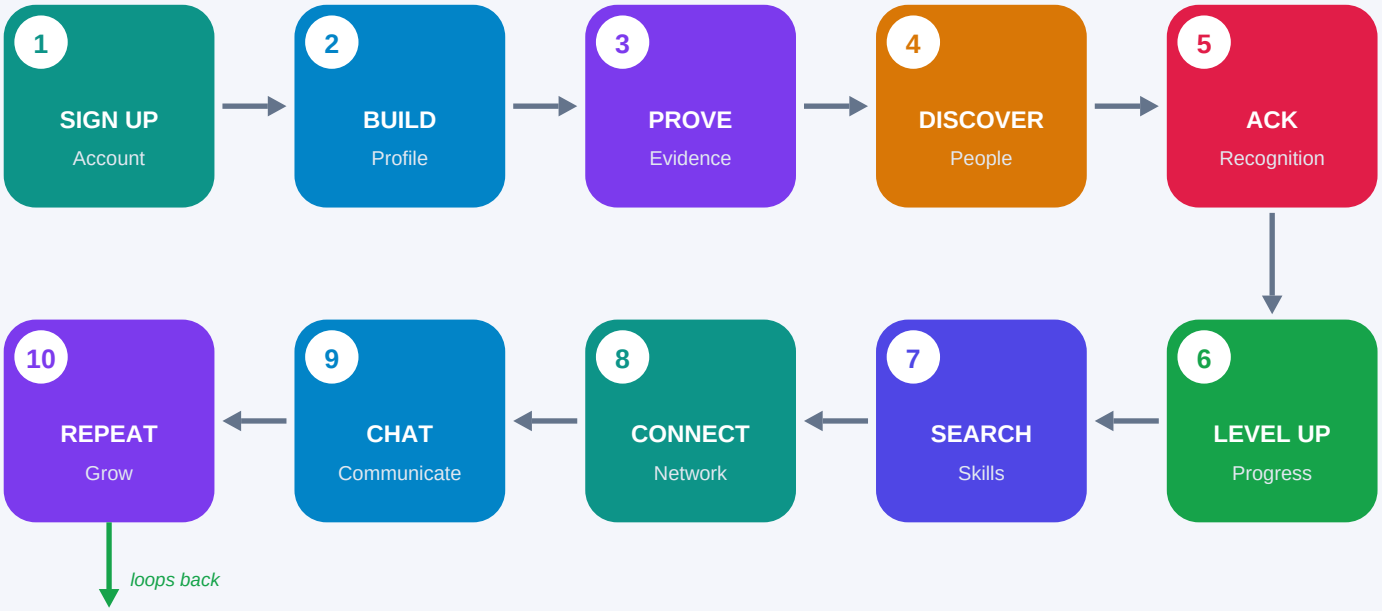
The connection model is separate from acknowledgement so social relationships do **not** automatically inflate reputation.

WHY IT MATTERS

Discovery by demonstrated skill is how recruiters, collaborators and mentors find the right person, and the reason profiles need evidence behind every claim.

8 End-to-End User Journey

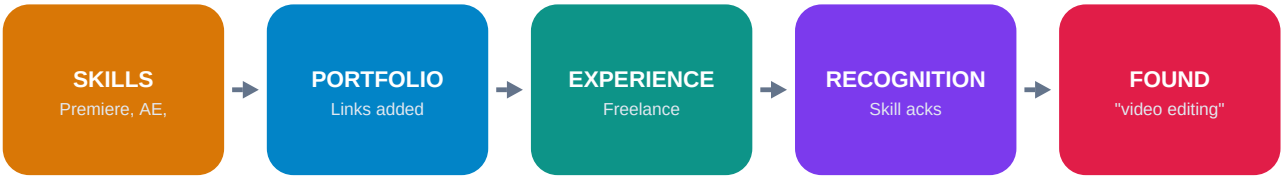
From sign-up to a growing network



EXAMPLE: SOFTWARE DEVELOPER

1. Creates profile
2. Adds React, Python and SQL
3. Adds GitHub projects
4. Adds internship
5. Other developers acknowledge React
6. Reputation grows
7. Profile moves to a new visual level
8. A recruiter/collaborator searches React
9. Finds the profile
10. Connects and chats

EXAMPLE: VIDEO EDITOR



Adds Premiere Pro, After Effects and Motion Graphics, links a portfolio, adds freelance experience and receives skill-specific acknowledgements, becoming discoverable when another user searches for video editing.

9 Main Screens / UX Blueprint

Ten screens that make up the product

01 Onboarding

Name, field, initial skills, profile photo, optional links

02 Home / Feed

Posts or updates, recommended people, skill discussions, activity

03 My Profile

Identity, level theme, skills, proof, experience, research, acknowledgements

04 Skill Detail

Skill name, acknowledgement count, evidence, projects, related people

05 Add Evidence

Type, title, description, link/file, date, skill mapping, visibility

06 Discover

Search bar, filters, people, skills, fields, level

07 Connections

Requests, accepted connections, suggested people

08 Chat

Messages, shared files, profile/skill cards

09 Level View

Current level, progression history, unlocked theme

10 Notifications

Acknowledgements, connection requests, messages, level-up events

10 Technical Architecture

A modular web app first; mobile and real-time later

A practical first version is a modular web application. The architecture should allow later mobile clients and real-time features without forcing an over-engineered MVP.

MVP STACK

FRONTEND

Next.js / React

Profile, search, feed, chat UI

BACKEND

Node.js + Express / NestJS

Business logic and APIs

DATABASE

PostgreSQL

Users, skills, evidence, acknowledgements

FILE STORAGE

Object storage

Certificates, documents, attachments

ADD LATER, WHEN USAGE JUSTIFIES

Mobile clients

iOS / Android apps

Real-time features

Live chat, notifications

Redis

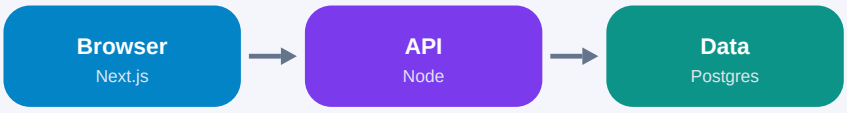
Caching and queues

Search infrastructure

Faster skill/person search

MVP SIMPLIFICATION

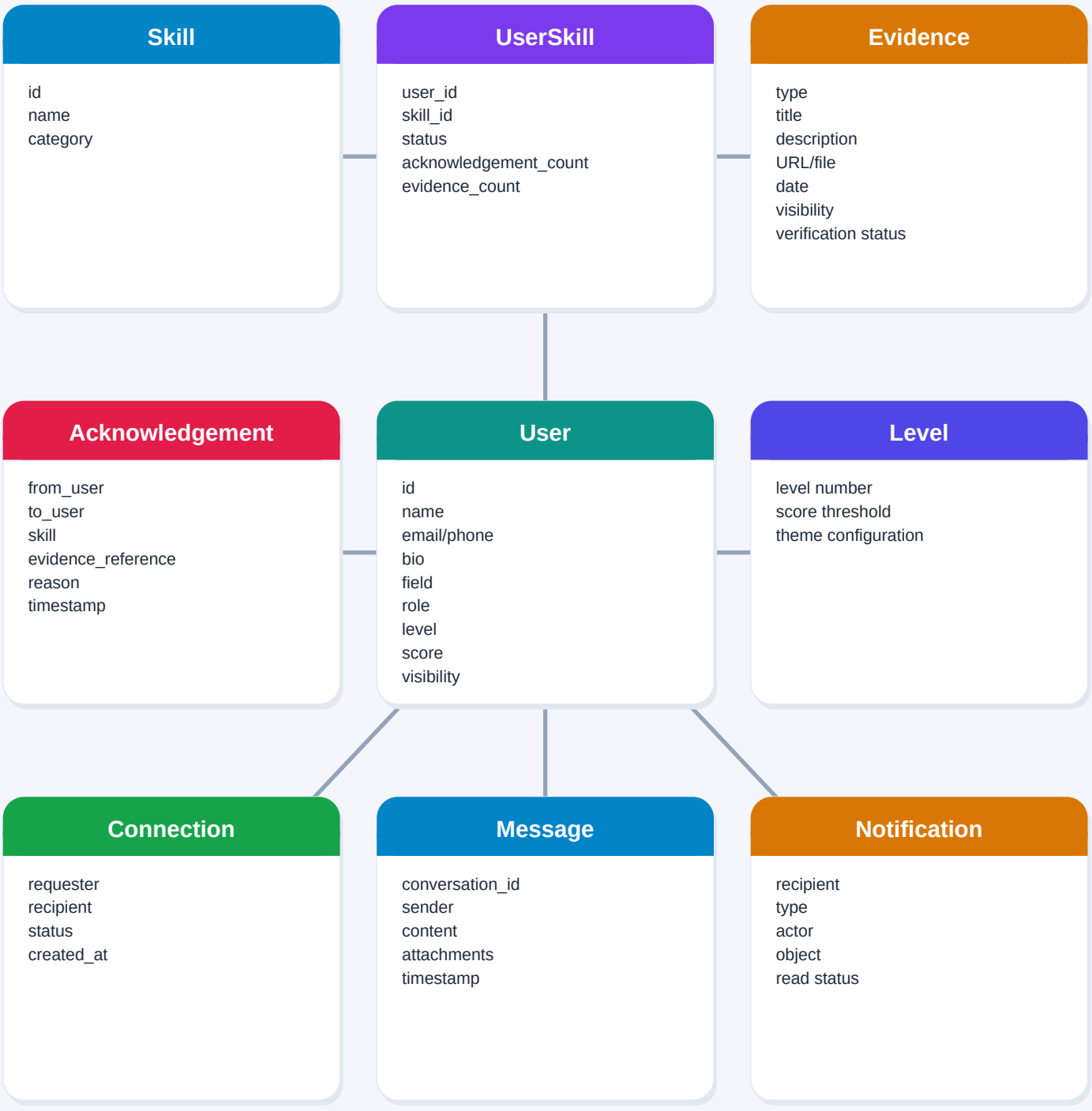
React/Next.js + Node/Express + PostgreSQL + object storage. Add Redis and search infrastructure **only when real usage justifies it**.



11

Core Data Model

Nine entities and how they relate



RELATIONSHIPS AT A GLANCE

- User has many UserSkills
- Evidence maps to a skill and user
- Connection links requester and recipient
- Skill is referenced by UserSkills
- Acknowledgement links two users and a skill
- Level defines theme and thresholds

12

MVP to Full Product Roadmap

Do not build the entire vision before testing the core loop

MVP 1 — CORE LOOP

BUILD

Auth + profile + skills + evidence

GOAL: Can users build credible profiles?

MVP 2 — CORE LOOP

BUILD

Acknowledgements + skill pages

GOAL: Will people recognize each other's skills?

MVP 3 — CORE LOOP

BUILD

Search + profiles + connections

GOAL: Can users discover useful people?

MVP 4 — CORE LOOP

BUILD

Chat + notifications

GOAL: Does discovery lead to communication?

V2 — SCALE

BUILD

Level engine + evolving themes

GOAL: Does progression make profiles memorable?

V3 — SCALE

BUILD

Verification + advanced search + moderation

GOAL: Can trust and scale improve?

V4 — SCALE

BUILD

Mobile apps + collaboration + richer social

GOAL: Can it become a larger network?

MVP SUCCESS CONDITION

Create profile → **Add** a skill → **Attach** evidence → **Receive** ack → **Be** discovered

RULE

Validate whether the core loop is valuable before building the full social network.

13 Build-in-Public Content Strategy

Document real decisions, failures, demos and milestones



Day 1	*"I'm building a social network where your profile can level up."*
Day 4	*"How should I decide whether someone is actually good at Python?"*
Day 9	*"I built the first acknowledgement system and immediately found a problem."*
Day 15	*"I made the Level 14 profile look prehistoric."*
Day 28	*"Someone finally used my app. Here's what they broke."*
Day 40	*"I changed the level algorithm after testing it with real users."*
Day 60	*"I opened the platform to the public."*

THE STORY

The story is not "I coded for 60 days." The story is **"I tried to turn an unusual idea into a real product, and this is what happened."**

14

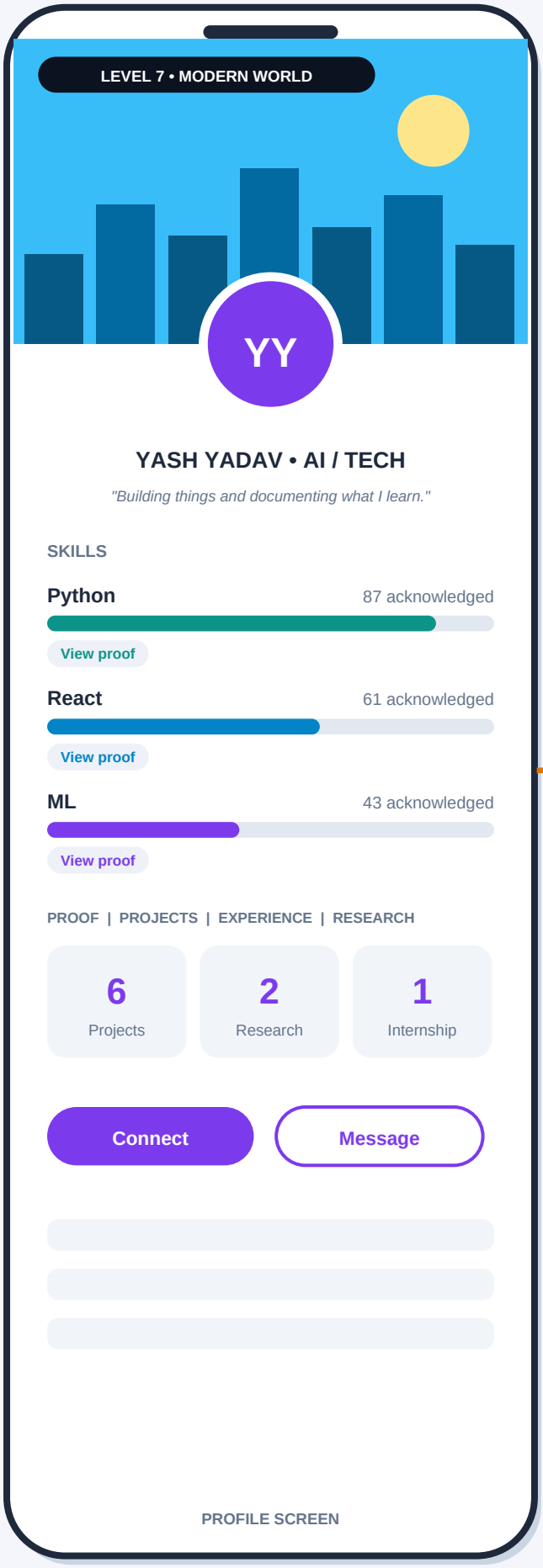
Major Product Risks & Solutions

What could go wrong, and the first response

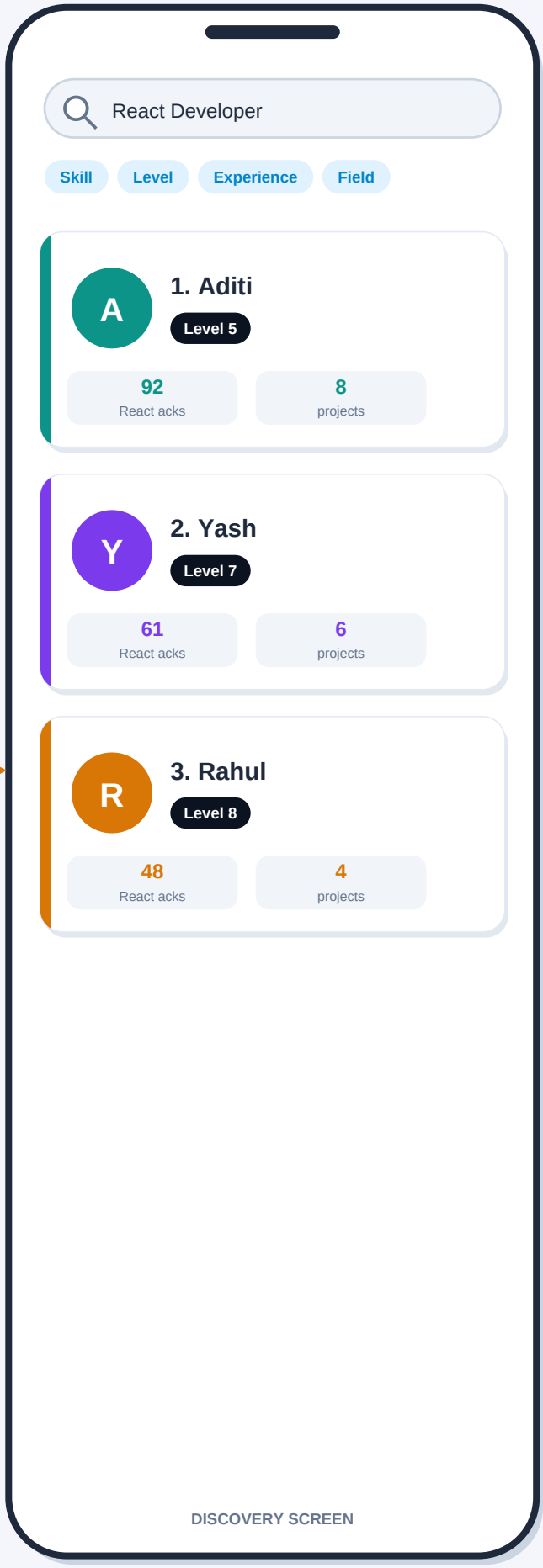
RISK	WHY IT MATTERS	INITIAL RESPONSE
Fake acknowledgements	Reputation becomes meaningless	Limits, trust signals, reasons, evidence-linked acknowledgement
Level gaming	Users optimize numbers instead of capability	Multi-signal score + diminishing returns
Certificate spam	Profiles become credential dumps	Evidence quality + projects/experience matter
Cold start	Empty network has little value	Seed with creator/student communities and invite loops
Privacy	Users may upload sensitive documents	Visibility controls, secure storage, deletion/export
Harassment / spam	Social features can be abused	Block/report/moderation/rate limits
Overbuilding	Huge scope delays launch	Validate the core loop before advanced features

15 Demonstration Wireframes

Conceptual layouts, not final UI designs



PROFILE SCREEN



DISCOVERY SCREEN

16

Final Product Definition

The product in one page

ONE-LINE

A social professional network where people build profiles around **skills and evidence**, earn skill-specific community recognition, connect and chat, and progress through an **evolving visual level system**.

THE DIFFERENTIATOR

The platform does not only display a resume. It turns professional identity into a living profile with evidence, community recognition and progression.

THE SIGNATURE

Level 14 starts as primitive humanity and Level 1 reaches a Mars-era civilization. The interface itself tells the story of progression.

THE FIRST THING TO BUILD



RECOMMENDED FIRST BUILD TARGET

Build a **web MVP** that lets **10 to 20 real people** create profiles and test the core reputation loop. Do not wait for the full social network.

MILESTONE

Users willing to create evidence, acknowledge others' skills and **return to improve** their profiles.

10-20 users | Web MVP | Core loop

This document is a product blueprint. Scoring weights, verification rules, level thresholds, privacy policies and visual themes should be validated through prototypes and real user testing before becoming permanent product rules.